

Emotional Intelligence in Leadership

Group - 6



ISE~3 PRESENTATION
ROLL NO : 61 ~ 69

AI&DS - B
3RD YEAR ~ 5TH SEMESTER
SSIC ~ SOFT SKILLS AND INTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION .



CASE STUDY : 1

Satya Nadella - A leader who used empathy and emotional intelligence to reshape Microsoft's culture and success.



CS1 : Background & EI Actions

- **Background (2014):**

- Microsoft had a stagnant culture, where hierarchy and internal rivalry slowed down innovation.
- Teams worked in silos, with little cross-functional communication.
- Market relevance was declining compared to competitors like Apple and Google.

- **Nadella's Leadership Approach (EI in Action):**

- **Promoted Empathy as Core Value** : Encouraged leaders to listen deeply to employees and customers, fostering trust.
- **Shifted from "Know-it-all" to "Learn-it-all" mindset** : Inspired continuous learning rather than arrogance.
- **Encouraged Collaboration over Competition** : Broke down silos, aligning teams toward shared goals.
- **Valued Diversity & Inclusion** : Supported cultural awareness and global perspectives to drive innovation.
- **Work-Life Balance Focus** : Emphasized humane leadership, showing care for employee well-being.

CS1 : Outcomes of EI in Leadership

- **Outcomes :**

- **Cultural Transformation** : Microsoft shifted from rigid silos to a culture of innovation, openness, and teamwork.
- **Employee Engagement** : Morale improved, with employees feeling valued, heard, and motivated.
- **Business Growth** : Market value tripled within a few years, making Microsoft one of the most valuable companies again.
- **Global Leadership** : Positioned Microsoft as a leader in cloud computing, AI, and digital transformation.

- **Key Learnings:**

- **EI = Leadership Power** : Emotional Intelligence is as vital as technical or business acumen.
- **Empathy + Inclusivity = Innovation** : Understanding people drives creativity and resilience.
- **Revival through EI** : Even large organizations can reinvent themselves when leaders practice strong EI.



CASE STUDY : 2

"One of the criticisms I've faced over the years is that I'm not aggressive enough or assertive enough, or maybe somehow, because I'm empathetic, it means I'm weak. I totally rebel against that. I refuse to believe that you cannot be both compassionate and strong."



CS2 : Background & EI Actions

- **Background:**

- Jacinda Ardern became the youngest female Prime Minister of New Zealand in over 150 years (2017).
- She led during unprecedented crises: the Christchurch mosque shootings (2019), the White Island volcanic eruption (2019), and the global COVID-19 pandemic (2020).

- **EI in Action :**

- **Empathy:** After the Christchurch attacks, she comforted grieving families personally, wore a hijab as a gesture of respect, and declared “They are us”, uniting the nation against hate.
- **Clear & Calm Communication :** During the pandemic, her daily briefings combined facts with reassurance, helping New Zealand achieve one of the world’s lowest early COVID-19 mortality rates.
- **Authenticity & Humility :** She often acknowledged uncertainties (“I don’t have all the answers, but together we can find them”), which made people trust her even more.
- **Compassion with Strength :** Balanced kindness with decisive action — for example, implementing strict gun law reforms within weeks of the Christchurch tragedy.
- **Global Recognition :** Admired worldwide as a leader who balances emotional intelligence with political decisiveness, making her a role model for empathetic governance.

CS2 : Outcomes of EI in Leadership

- **Outcomes**

- **Effective Crisis Management:** New Zealand's COVID-19 response (strict lockdowns, clear communication, early border control) was recognized globally as one of the most effective.
- **Restoration of Trust in Leadership:** Citizens felt valued and protected, leading to higher public confidence in government decisions.
- **Unity During Tragedy:** After the Christchurch mosque shootings, Ardern's empathetic actions fostered solidarity and reduced communal tensions.

- **Key Learnings**

- **Empathy Builds Trust:** Genuine care and understanding foster loyalty and cooperation, even during difficult times.
- **Authentic Communication Reduces Fear:** Honest, transparent communication creates clarity and prevents the spread of panic or misinformation.
- **Emotional Intelligence Enhances Resilience:** Leaders who manage emotions effectively can inspire teams, communities, and nations to endure crises with strength and unity.



CASE STUDY : 3

Sundar Pichai's leadership at Google shows how empathy, humility, and emotional intelligence can drive innovation, unity, and sustainable success in the tech world.



CS3 : Background & EI Actions

- **Background**

- Sundar Pichai became CEO of Google in 2015 and later Alphabet in 2019.
- Took over during a time when Google faced criticism over employee dissatisfaction, data privacy concerns, and the challenges of maintaining innovation at scale.
- Known for his calm, humble, and empathetic leadership style, contrasting with the aggressive, high-pressure culture often seen in Silicon Valley.

- **EI in Action :**

- **Empathy with Employees:** He held open forums, listened to employee concerns (e.g., walkouts over workplace policies), and ensured their voices were acknowledged.
- **Calm Decision-Making:** Pichai is known for staying composed under pressure, focusing on facts and fairness in high-stress situations.
- **Inclusive Leadership:** Promotes collaboration and inclusivity by valuing diverse perspectives and encouraging team innovation.
- **Humility and Authenticity:** Unlike many high-profile CEOs, Pichai avoids flamboyance, instead demonstrating humility that strengthens trust internally and externally.

CS4 : Outcomes of EI in Leadership

- **Outcomes :**

- Sustained Google's global leadership in AI, cloud, and digital platforms.
- Improved employee trust through open communication and empathy during workplace crises.
- Enhanced Google's reputation as a people-first and innovation-driven company.
- Maintained stability and focus during controversies and rapid tech transformations.

- **Key Learnings:**

- Humility and empathy are powerful leadership assets in large organizations.
- Inclusive leadership builds stronger innovation and employee engagement.
- Emotional intelligence fosters resilience, trust, and long-term success even in competitive, high-pressure industries.



CASE STUDY : 4

Indra Nooyi's leadership at PepsiCo showed how empathy, authenticity, and a people-first approach can balance business success with social responsibility.



CS4 : Background & EI Actions

- **Background :**

- Indra Nooyi became CEO of PepsiCo in 2006, one of the first women and women of color to lead a Fortune 500 company.
- She inherited challenges of rising health concerns over sugary drinks and intense competition in the global food industry.

- **EI in Action :**

- **Empathy** : Wrote personal letters to parents of senior executives, appreciating their contribution in shaping leaders.
- **Vision & Inclusivity** : Promoted "Performance with Purpose," balancing profit with sustainability, health, and social responsibility.
- **Authenticity** : Openly communicated challenges, encouraging innovation in healthier product lines.
- **Relationship Management** : Built strong bonds with employees, investors, and communities, inspiring loyalty and trust.

CS4 : Outcomes of EI in Leadership

- **Outcomes:**

- **Strategic Transformation** : Shifted PepsiCo's focus from "fun-for-you" to "better-for-you" products, expanding into healthier snacks and beverages.
- **Global Reputation** : PepsiCo was recognized for sustainability initiatives, reducing packaging waste, and promoting healthier lifestyles.
- **Employee Engagement** : Her empathetic approach, like writing letters to employees' families, built loyalty and trust within the organization.
- **Diversity & Inclusion** : Advocated for women and minority leaders, creating a more inclusive workplace.
- **Global Recognition** : Became one of the most respected CEOs, inspiring leaders worldwide with her balance of business acumen and empathy.

- **Key Learnings:**

- Emotional intelligence is not a "soft skill" but a strategic asset for long-term corporate success.
- Empathy and inclusivity create stronger employee commitment and brand trust.
- Leaders who combine business vision with emotional awareness can achieve both profitability and positive societal impact.

CASE STUDY

FINDINGS

- **EI drives cultural transformation** : Nadella shifted Microsoft from rigid silos to collaboration.
- **EI sustains performance under crisis** : NASA's Apollo 13 mission succeeded due to calm, emotionally intelligent leadership.
- **EI builds national trust** : Jacinda Ardern showed empathy and authenticity, uniting New Zealand during crises.
- **EI encourages innovation & well-being** : Google's leaders fostered psychological safety, boosting creativity.
- **EI humanizes global corporations** : Indra Nooyi balanced profitability with empathy and inclusivity at PepsiCo.



CONCLUSION

- **EI balances IQ and EQ** : Technical skills alone are not enough; emotional skills complete effective leadership.
- **Builds trust and collaboration** : Leaders with EI foster stronger bonds within teams and organizations.
- **Enables resilience in crises** : Staying calm and empathetic under pressure ensures better outcomes.
- **Drives innovation and growth** : An emotionally intelligent culture encourages creativity and adaptability.
- **Humanizes leadership** : Empathy, inclusivity, and authentic communication make leaders more relatable.
- **Sustains long-term success** : EI enhances employee engagement, stakeholder trust, and organizational reputation.



Thank You

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